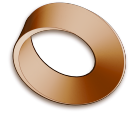


Name: _____

Date: _____

Mr. Rawson • Y9 MYP Design



3a.10 – Choosing a Font

Unit 3a: Interactive Animations & Games

Learning intentions

By the end of this page you can:

- use `textFont()` to change how your text looks;
- explain *why* code.org only lets you choose from a short list of fonts;
- pick a font for your card's message and a different one for its title.

1 Changing your font

By default, every piece of text you draw uses **Arial, size 12**. `textFont()` sets the typeface, `textSize()` sets the size in pixels — put both **before** the `text()` line you want them to affect, like `fill()`:

```
textFont("Georgia"); textSize(24); text("Happy Birthday", 50, 200);
```

2 Why can't I just use any font?

A font only works on your card if the computer displaying it **already has that font installed** — ask for one nobody else has, and their browser silently swaps in something else. **Web safe fonts** are the small set installed on *almost every computer* already, which is exactly why `textFont()` only accepts one from this list: it guarantees your card looks the same on every screen.

3 Your 9 allowed fonts

Type	Fonts
Sans-serif	Arial, Verdana, Tahoma, Trebuchet MS
Serif	Times New Roman, Georgia, Garamond
Monospace	Courier New
Cursive	Brush Script MT

Type the name **exactly** as spelled above, inside quotation marks. Turn the page to see what each one actually looks like.

Activity

Before you start coding Look at the samples overleaf and choose:

- **Message font** (the main text on your card): _____
- **Title font** (a heading, if your card has one — pick a *different* font to the message, so it stands out): _____

Font Samples

“The quick brown fox jumps over the lazy dog” — and why a designer might pick each one

Serif fonts have small ticks (“feet”) at the ends of the letters. **Sans-serif** (*sans* = without) fonts don’t — plainer, cleaner strokes.

Sans-serif

Arial

The quick brown fox jumps over the lazy dog

Microsoft’s default font for 15 years (1992–2007) — neutral, safe, the one everyone has seen

Verdana

The quick brown fox jumps over the lazy dog

Built for tiny screens — very clear even at a small size; feels friendly, approachable

Tahoma

The quick brown fox jumps over the lazy dog

Tighter and denser than Verdana — feels efficient, no-nonsense, businesslike

Trebuchet MS

The quick brown fox jumps over the lazy dog

Rounder, warmer curves than Arial — friendly, modern, a little playful

Serif

Times New Roman

The quick brown fox jumps over the lazy dog

The most common newspaper font — feels formal, traditional, official

Georgia

The quick brown fox jumps over the lazy dog

A serif made for screens — warmer and easier to read than Times

Garamond

The quick brown fox jumps over the lazy dog

An elegant, old-fashioned font used in books — feels literary, refined

Monospace

Courier New

The quick brown fox jumps over the lazy dog

*An old typewriter font — **monospace** means every letter is the same width; feels technical*

Cursive

Brush Script MT

The quick brown fox jumps over the lazy dog

The one handwriting-style font on the list — casual, personal; a signature or a greeting